Proposal: Moving the team wiki to plain Markdown

Summary

Our wiki currently lives in a hosted service that we pay for per seat. Most pages are edited by two or three people, and almost nobody uses the features that set it apart from a folder of text files. This proposal recommends moving the wiki into a Git repository as plain Markdown, reviewed through the same pull requests we use for code.

Motivation

The hosted wiki has three problems:

1. **Cost.** We pay for 40 seats, but only 12 people edited a page last quarter.
2. **Drift.** Pages describe how systems worked when they were written. Nothing ties a page to the code it describes, so nobody notices when it goes stale.
3. **Review.** Edits go live immediately. There is no way to propose a change and have someone else look at it first.

Keeping documentation next to the code solves all three. It is free, it changes in the same commits as the code, and every change is reviewed.

Plan

We will export every page to Markdown using the wiki's built-in exporter, commit the result to a new `docs/` directory, and fix broken links by hand. The migration should take about a week. After that, the hosted wiki becomes read-only for one month and is then shut down.

Risks

Non-engineers may find Git intimidating. We can mitigate this by allowing edits through the web interface of our Git host, which needs no local setup.

Search will be worse at first, since the hosted wiki has full-text search built in. A static site generator would give us search back, but that is out of scope for now.

Decision

We ask the team to approve the migration by the end of the month.